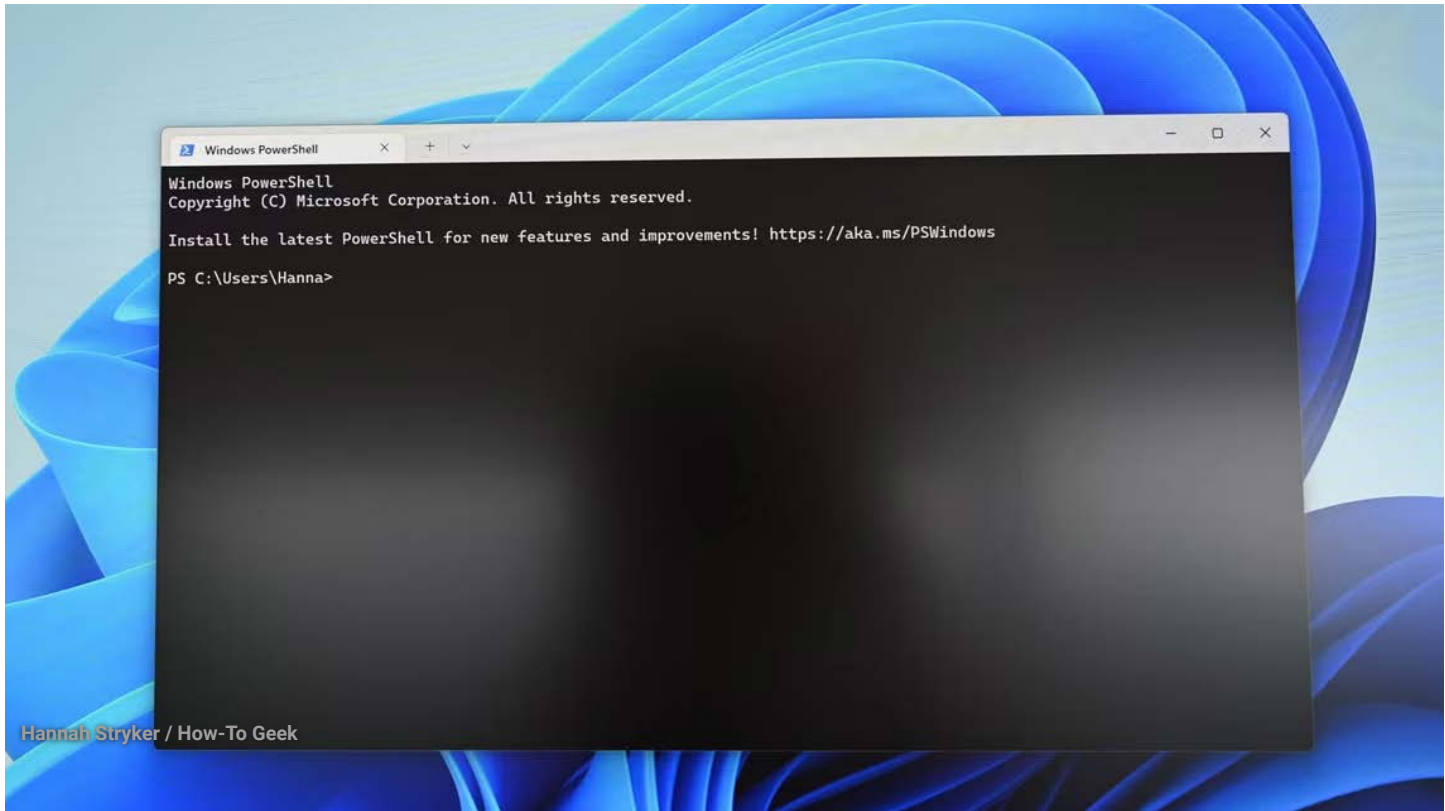


Home > Windows

How to Open JAR Files on Windows 10 and 11

A little bit different from opening a pickle jar.

BY MAHESH MAKVANA UPDATED SEP 23, 2023



Readers like you help support How-To Geek. When you make a purchase using links on our site, we may earn an affiliate commission. [Read More.](#)

Quick Links

What Is a JAR File and How Can You Open One?
Step 1: Check if Java Is Already Installed on Your PC
Step 2: Download and Install Java on Windows
Step 3: Run JAR Files on Windows 10 or Windows 11
Optional: Extract Files From a JAR File

KEY TAKEAWAYS

To run a JAR file on Windows 10 or Windows 11, right-click it, then select Open With > Java. [Link copied to clipboard](#) Alternatively, you can view or extract the contents of a JAR file by opening it in a program like WinRAR.

On Windows 10 and Windows 11, JAR files don't open by default as there are no built-in apps to handle this file format. But, you can install the free Java utility and access this file format on your PC. We'll show you the process to do that.

What Is a JAR File and How Can You Open One?

JAR stands for Java Archive, which is an archive comprising multiple files. Developers can make apps and other items in Java and save those files as JAR. It's worth keeping in mind, though, that JAR files contain executable code making them potentially dangerous file types. Make sure you trust the source of your JAR file before running it.

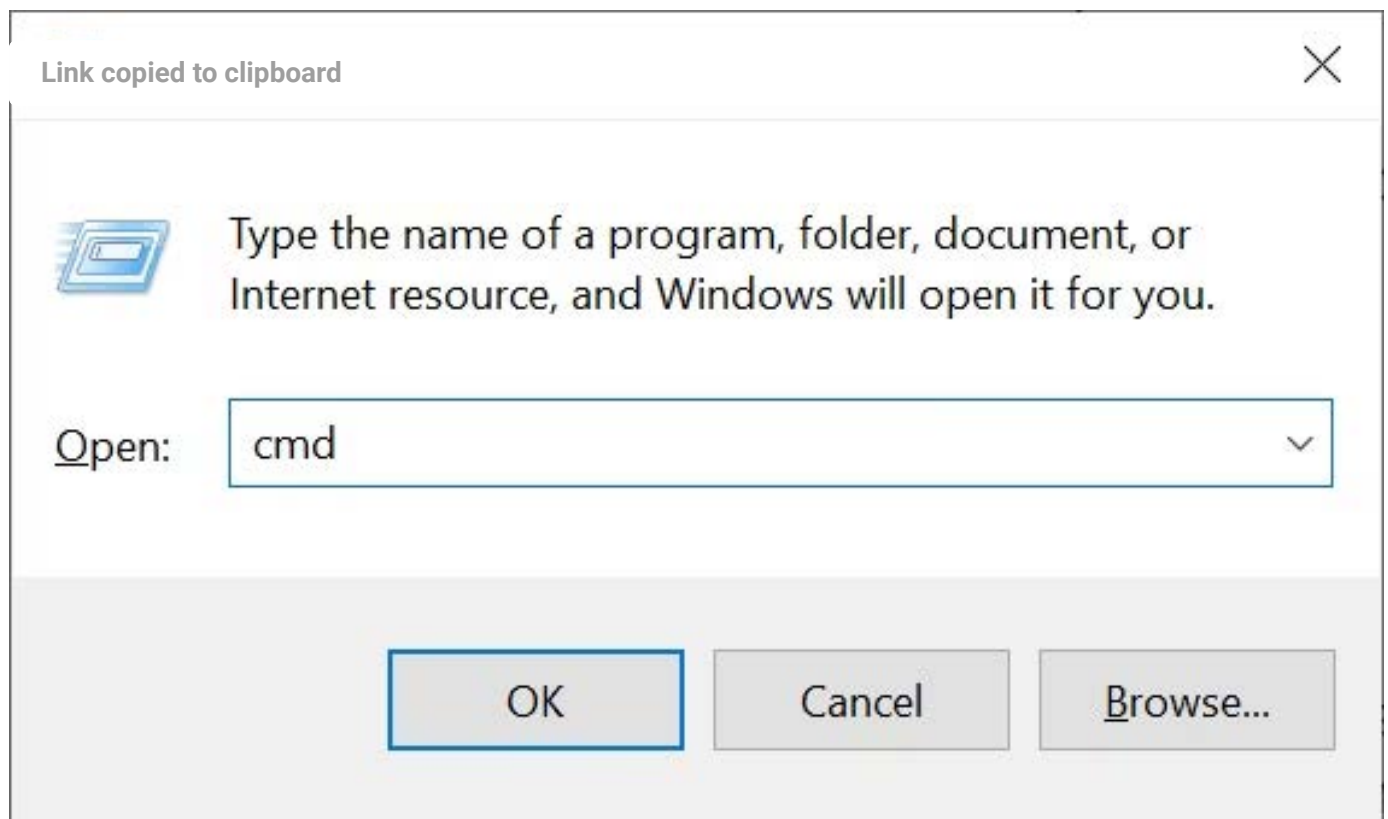
To run a JAR file on your Windows PC, you have to install the free Java utility. Then, you can double-click your JAR file to launch it. You can also extract the files out of a JAR archive using a free app like WinRAR, as we'll explain below.

Step 1: Check if Java Is Already Installed on Your PC

It's worth checking if you have Java installed on your PC already, and if so, you can skip the Step 2 below.

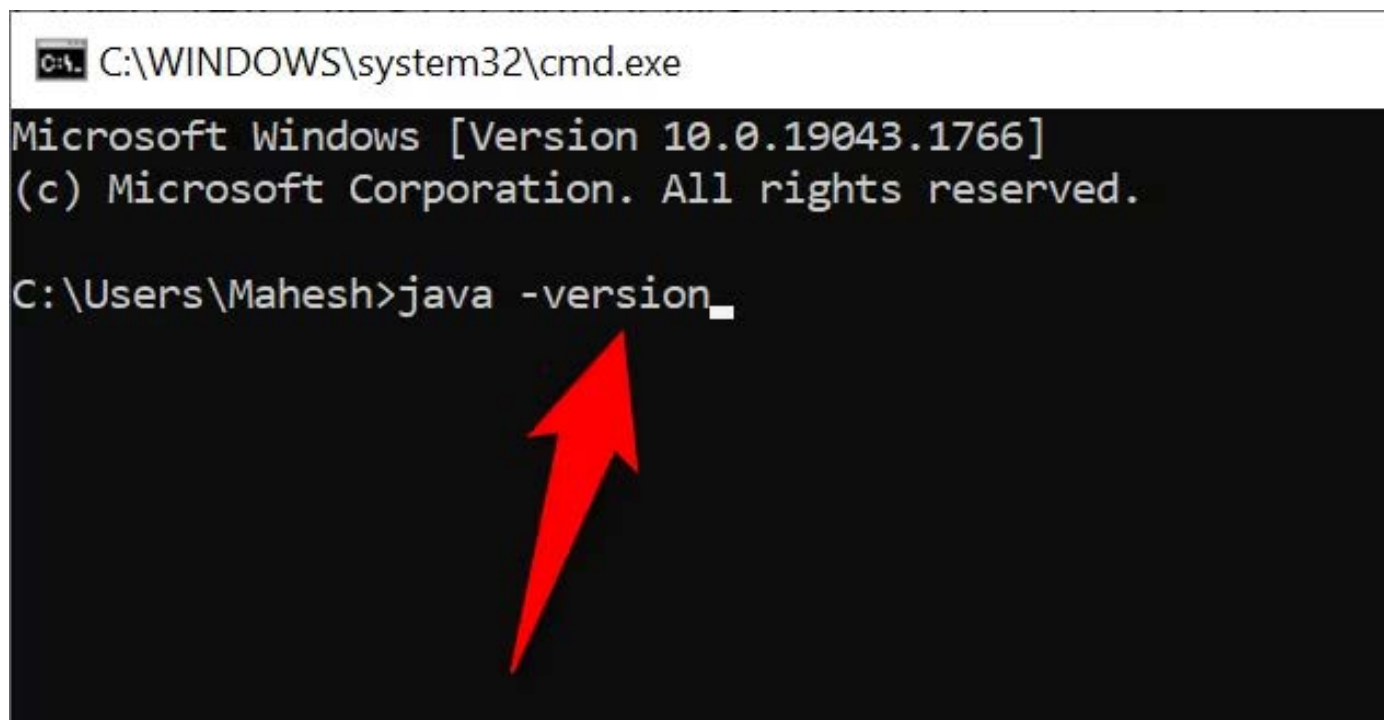
To do that, first, launch the Run box by pressing Windows+R. Then, type the following in the box and press Enter:

```
cmd
```

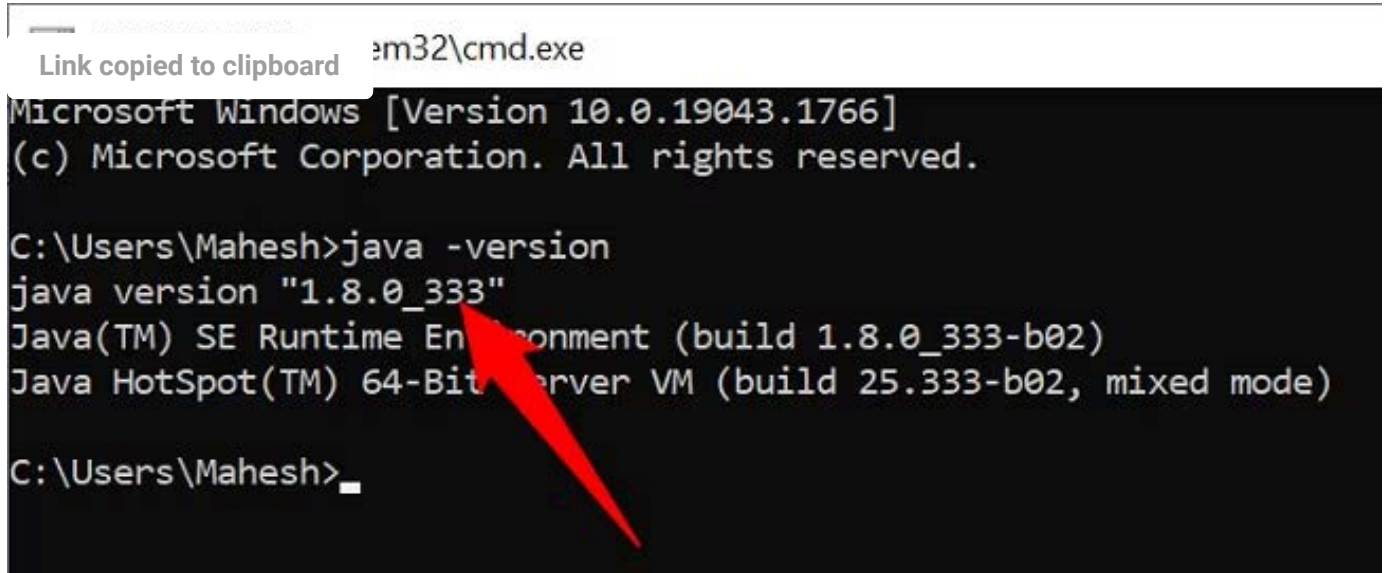


In the Command Prompt window that opens, type the following command and press Enter:

```
java -version
```



If you have Java installed on your PC, you'll see your Java version. In this case, skip Step 2 below and head straight to Step 3.



A screenshot of a Windows Command Prompt window. The title bar shows 'C:\WINDOWS\system32\cmd.exe'. The text in the window reads: 'Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.19043.1766] (c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved. C:\Users\Mahesh>java -version java version "1.8.0_333" Java(TM) SE Runtime Environment (build 1.8.0_333-b02) Java HotSpot(TM) 64-Bit Server VM (build 25.333-b02, mixed mode) C:\Users\Mahesh>'. A red arrow points to the output of the 'java -version' command.

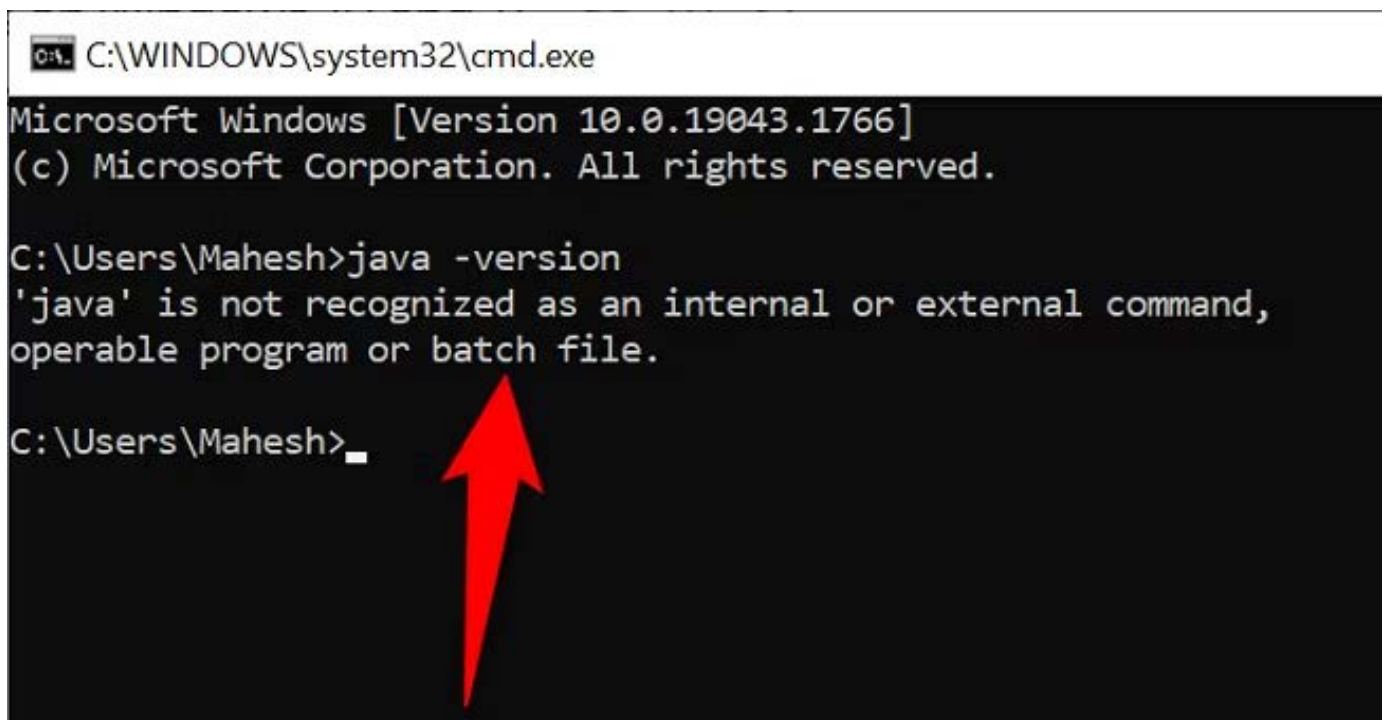
```
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.19043.1766]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\Mahesh>java -version
java version "1.8.0_333"
Java(TM) SE Runtime Environment (build 1.8.0_333-b02)
Java HotSpot(TM) 64-Bit Server VM (build 25.333-b02, mixed mode)

C:\Users\Mahesh>
```

If Command Prompt displays the following message, then you don't have Java installed. In this case, install the utility using [Step 2](#) below.

'java' is not recognized as an internal or external command, operable program or batch file.



A screenshot of a Windows Command Prompt window. The title bar shows 'C:\WINDOWS\system32\cmd.exe'. The text in the window reads: 'Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.19043.1766] (c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved. C:\Users\Mahesh>java -version 'java' is not recognized as an internal or external command, operable program or batch file. C:\Users\Mahesh>'. A red arrow points to the error message.

```
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.19043.1766]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\Mahesh>java -version
'java' is not recognized as an internal or external command,
operable program or batch file.

C:\Users\Mahesh>
```

Step 2: Download and Install Java on Windows

You can download and install Java for free on your Windows PC.

To do that, first, launch a web browser on your computer and open the [Java download web page](#).

Link copied to clipboard

action, download the appropriate file for your machine.

 **Windows**  **Which download should I choose?**

 Windows Online filesize: 2.15 MB	Instructions	After installing Java, you may need to restart your browser in order to enable Java in your browser.
 Windows Offline filesize: 72.39 MB	Instructions	
 Windows Offline (64-bit) filesize: 83.03 MB	Instructions	

If you use 32-bit and 64-bit browsers interchangeably, you will need to install both 32-bit and 64-bit Java in order to have the Java plug-in for both browsers. » [FAQ about 64-bit Java for Windows](#)

When Java is downloaded, double-click the installer file to install the utility on your PC. Then, restart your [Windows 10](#) or [Windows 11](#) PC.

Step 3: Run JAR Files on Windows 10 or Windows 11

Now that you have Java installed, you're ready to launch your JAR files.

To do that, first, [open a File Explorer window](#) and locate your JAR file.

Link copied to clipboard

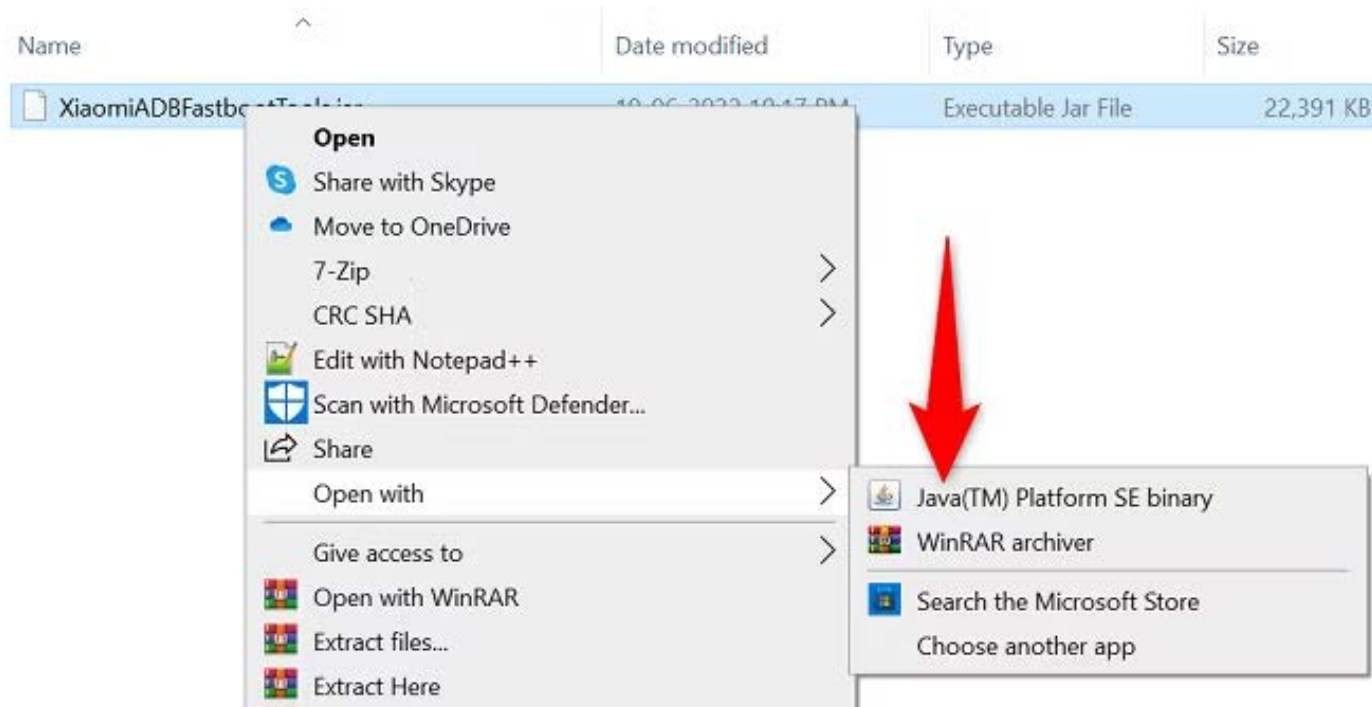
Name	Date modified	Type
 XiaomiADBFastbootTools.jar	19-06-2022 10:17 PM	Executable Jar File



Right-click your JAR file and choose Open With > Java(TM) Platform SE Binary.

Tip

If you don't see that option in the "Open With" menu, then click "Choose Another App" and you'll see the option.



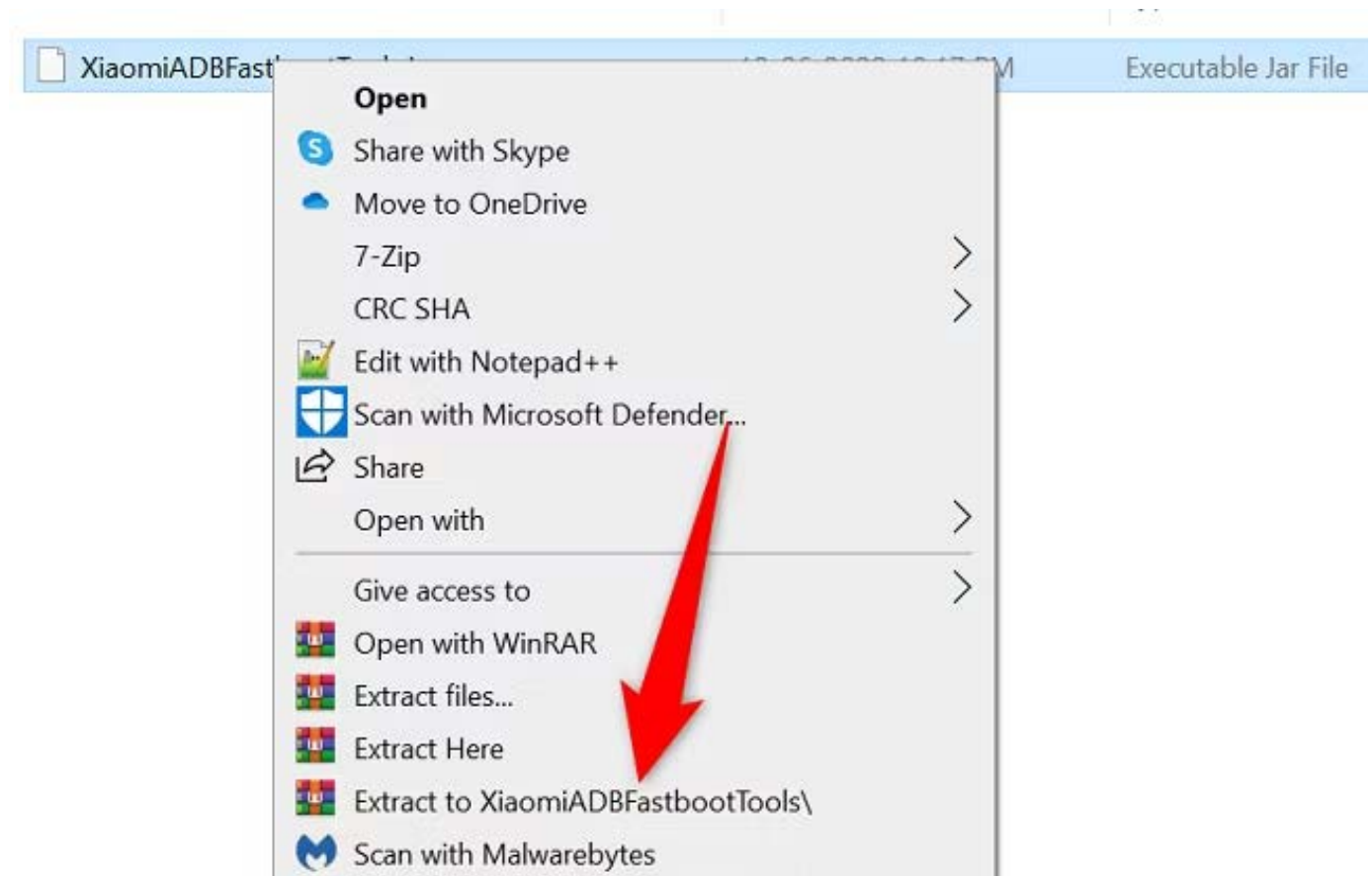
Your JAR file will launch and you'll be able to interact with it. And that's all there is to it.

Optional: Extract Files From a JAR File

If instead of running it you'd like to extract the files from your JAR file, you can do so using a free [Link copied to clipboard](#) WinRAR.

To start, install the free version of [WinRAR](#) on your PC. Then [restart your PC](#).

In a File Explorer window, locate your JAR file. Then right-click the file and choose "Extract To [JAR File Name]."



WinRAR will make a new folder in your current folder. This new folder has all the files extracted from your JAR file.

And that's how you access as well as take an insider look at your JAR files on Windows. Enjoy!

Did you know certain [file types can potentially harm your Windows PC](#)? Check out our list of such file types so you're aware.

The Best Tech Newsletter Around

Email Address